PROJECT REPORT

30/03/2026 2025-2026 First Year

Rabhya Grover CSE0001 25BMR10015

Project Overview and Scenario

As part of the CSE0001 - Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University, I have been appointed to the role of Student Digital Ambassador. This specialized role tasks me with serving as a peer mentor to help other students navigate the complexities of the modern digital landscape, ensuring they can communicate safely, responsibly, and professionally.

To fulfill the requirements of this ambassadorship, I am building a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio. This portfolio is organized within a dedicated GitHub repository and is designed to demonstrate my proficiency across five core modules: visual communication, professional networking, technical platform engagement, digital etiquette, and cybercrime awareness.

The project follows a structured scenario where I must present my findings and resources to a faculty committee while sharing these insights with my batchmates to bridge the "digital divide". By documenting my work through infographics, professional profiles, coding challenges, and safety checklists, this project serves as both an internal academic assessment and a permanent digital asset for my future career.

Task 1 Reflection: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

To fulfill the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, I designed an original awareness infographic using Canva, a versatile and user-friendly web-based design tool. I chose this platform because its extensive library of templates and drag-and-drop interface allowed me to create a professional-grade visual without requiring advanced graphic design skills.

My design is structured to provide a clear, high-level overview of digital literacy for my peers. It specifically highlights three essential pillars: a clear definition of digital literacy, a list of essential digital tools for B.Tech students (such as GitHub and LinkedIn), and a section dedicated to safe internet practices like identifying phishing attempts. I used a clean, modern layout with high-contrast colors and intuitive icons to ensure the information is easily scannable for students on the go.

One thing I found particularly interesting during the design process was the challenge of "visual hierarchy"—the art of arranging elements so that the most important information catches the eye first. Balancing the text-heavy sections on cyber-safety with engaging graphics was difficult, but it taught me that effective digital communication is as much about what you leave out as what you include.

Task 2 Reflection: Building a Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I established my professional digital presence by setting up and updating profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. I chose these platforms because they represent the essential trifecta of modern engineering: version control, professional networking, and data science practice. GitHub serves as my digital showroom for code and technical projects , LinkedIn acts as my professional identity and bridge to industry experts , and Kaggle provides a specialized environment to compete and learn in the field of machine learning and data analysis.

Over the next four years, I plan to use these tools as a living record of my growth. On GitHub, I will consistently commit my academic projects and open-source contributions to build a strong "green-square" contribution graph. I will use LinkedIn to share my certifications, connect with alumni,

and stay updated on internship trends. Finally, I will use Kaggle to refine my Python skills through real-world datasets. By maintaining these profiles regularly, I aim to transition from a student to a job-ready professional with a verified track record by the time I graduate.

Task 3 Reflection: Exploring Coding and Collaboration Platforms

To fulfill the requirements of Module 3, I utilized HackerRank for technical practice and Google Forms for digital collaboration. On HackerRank, I successfully completed the "Solve Me First" Python challenge, which allowed me to practice basic input/output logic and familiarize myself with competitive coding environments. Additionally, I developed a five-question "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms, which included a mix of multiple-choice and short-answer questions designed to test the digital proficiency of my peers.

These tools provide a significant academic advantage. HackerRank serves as a vital platform for mastering the programming languages required in my B.Tech curriculum, helping me prepare for technical lab assessments and future placements. Meanwhile, Google Forms and the linked Google Sheets response view are essential for conducting data-driven research and managing group projects efficiently in a cloud-based setting. By mastering these platforms, I have transitioned from being a basic user to a more capable digital collaborator, ready to handle the technical and organizational demands of my engineering degree.

Task 4 Reflection: The Impact of Poor Digital Communication

A common situation where poor digital communication causes significant problems is the "vague subject line" scenario in a professional setting. For example, a student might send an email to a professor with the subject line "Help" or "Assignment," containing a one-sentence query without a formal

greeting or context. This often leads to the email being ignored or buried in a crowded inbox, causing the student to miss critical deadlines.

To prevent this, the student should have used a structured subject line, such as "Query: CSE0001 Assignment 2 - [Name]," and included a professional salutation. By clearly stating the issue in the first paragraph and using a polite, formal tone, the student would have demonstrated respect for the professor's time. This experience taught me that digital etiquette is not just about politeness; it is a functional tool for ensuring your message is received and acted upon effectively.

Something like this happened to me once. I wrote a vague E-mail to my professor for my unexpectedly low marks. As the e-mail was vague, my prof. Ignored it and as a result my marks remained the same. If I had written the e-mail formally this wouldn’t have happened. As a consequence I got bad marks resulting in a bad grade.

Task 5 Reflection: Cybercrime Awareness & Prevention

What surprised me most while researching Phishing and UPI fraud was the sheer psychological sophistication of modern "Social Engineering" attacks. I previously believed that cybercrime was mostly about complex coding or "hacking" into systems, but I discovered that most attackers simply exploit human emotions like urgency, fear, or curiosity to steal credentials. Realizing how easily a professional-looking SMS or a spoofed website can deceive even tech-savvy students was eye-opening.

As a result of this research, the one habit I will personally change is my approach to Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and link verification. I have committed to never clicking on "urgent" links in SMS messages and will always manually navigate to official bank websites or apps instead. Additionally, I will now use a dedicated authenticator app for my primary accounts rather than relying solely on SMS-based OTPs, which can be

intercepted.

Conclusion

Completing this Digital Literacy Portfolio has transformed my understanding of what it means to be a "Student Digital Ambassador". By integrating technical skills like version control on GitHub with professional communication and cyber-awareness, I have built a foundation that goes far beyond basic internet usage. This project taught me that digital literacy is not just about using tools, but about practicing responsibility, maintaining a professional identity, and ensuring personal and community safety in an increasingly complex online world. I am now better equipped to navigate my four-year B.Tech journey and guide my peers toward becoming responsible digital citizens.